

SC.2 Permit Application Checklist

The code editions actually in force, the amendments that change what you buy, and what to gather before you file.

Before you use this document

This is a process reference, not legal advice. South Carolina is a mandatory-enforcement state: § 6-9-10 orders every municipality and county to enforce the state code, and to enforce *only* that code, so the question that dominates most states in this series — will anyone inspect this house? — has a statutory answer here. What South Carolina replaces it with is a stack of small obligations with hard consequences: a disclosure you sign in person, a notice you file at the register of deeds afterwards, an energy code fixed by statute rather than by the code council, and a coastline the law forbids anyone to describe county by county. Fees, portals, review queues and the extra permits your particular lot triggers still vary. Confirm every item with the office that will actually handle your parcel before you rely on it.

WHAT IS ACTUALLY IN FORCE

South Carolina adopts the model codes statewide and amends them in one place. Section 6-9-55(A) requires the Building Codes Council to “promulgate as regulations... any provision of or amendment to any building code that would affect construction requirements for one-family or two-family dwellings” — and says that until it does, the provision “shall not be enforced.” So the amendments are not a handout. They are **Articles 8 through 14 of Chapter 8 of the S.C. Code of Regulations**, and each article opens by naming its edition.

South Carolina code editions, from the regulation that carries them

Discipline	Edition in force	Where it says so
Residential	2021 International Residential Code, as modified	Reg. Art. 12, R.8-1200
Building	2021 International Building Code, as modified — non-residential	Reg. Art. 8, R.8-800
Electrical	2020 National Electrical Code, as modified. Note the year: it does <i>not</i> track the 2021 suite.	Reg. Art. 11, R.8-1100
Plumbing	2021 International Plumbing Code, as modified	Reg. Art. 14, R.8-1400
Mechanical	2021 International Mechanical Code, as modified	Reg. Art. 13, R.8-1300
Fuel gas	2021 International Fuel Gas Code, as modified	Reg. Art. 10
Fire	2021 International Fire Code, as modified	Reg. Art. 9
Energy	2009 IECC — set by statute, not by the Council. The Council “does not adopt IRC Chapter 11.” See below.	§ 6-10-30; R.8-1230

Each article states it the same way — R.8-1200: “This code is identical to the 2021 Edition of the International Residential Code except for the following modifications.” Read them free at scstatehouse.gov/coderegs/ — Chapter 8 is one PDF. Statewide modifications “shall be mandatory for all jurisdictions in the state” (R.8-240(K)), and local governments “are prohibited from writing or publishing any other building codes in part or in whole” (R.8-236(C)).

Do not use the PDF on the Council's own Codes page

The Building Codes Council's website has a Codes menu with a link named *Residential Code*. As of September 2026 that link serves a scanned copy of *South Carolina State Register* Vol. 43, Issue 5, dated 24 May 2019 — Document No. 4868, headed “2018 International Residential Code Modification Summary.” It is a code edition and several amendment cycles out of date, and because it is a scan you cannot even search it.

The current text is Article 12 of Chapter 8 of the Code of Regulations, which carries the 2021 IRC modifications and was last amended effective 27 May 2022. If a plan reviewer quotes you a modification, check it there.

Two dates decide which edition your house is built to. Section 6-9-130(A) fixes it: “Buildings must be inspected in accordance with the codes in effect for the locality **on the date of the issuance of the original building permit**,” falling back to the date the completed application was submitted if no issuance date can be found. The regulation says the same from the other side: work “for which a completed building permit application has been approved prior to the implementation date... must be inspected under the building codes in effect at the time the original building permit was issued” (R.8-236(B)). **A new edition landing in the middle of your build does not move your job.** Keep the dated permit.

The current suite has a date on it. The Building Codes Council's own adoption notice records that **on 6 October 2021** it “adopted the latest editions of the mandatory codes and appendices with modifications, as referenced in S.C. Code Ann. § 6-9-50... to be enforced by all municipalities and counties in South Carolina,” and that “The Council established the **implementation date for local jurisdictions as January 1, 2023.**” The same notice lists the editions exactly as the regulation does, including the 2020 NEC and the 2009 IECC under the Energy Standard Act — and adds a warning worth keeping: “Only the modifications approved and listed on the Council's website are valid for use in the State. Building code modifications that have not been approved by the Council are invalid and cannot be adopted, employed or enforced by municipalities and counties.”

The codes above roll over on 1 January 2027 — and your permit date decides whether that reaches you

This is the most important date in this document, and it is close. On **26 August 2025** the Building Codes Council adopted the **2024** editions of the building, residential, fire, plumbing, mechanical and fuel gas codes together with the **2023 National Electrical Code**, and “established the implementation date for local jurisdictions as **January 1, 2027.**”

Everything printed in this kit is the stack in force **now** — the 2021 codes and the 2020 NEC, implemented 1 January 2023 — and it stays in force through the end of 2026. The one thing that does *not* move is the energy standard: the 2024 modification index says again that the 2009 IECC “has been statutorily adopted as the energy standard and is mandatory for use in all jurisdictions within the State.”

Here is what to do about it. Section 6-9-130(A) fixes your house to the codes in effect on the date your original building permit was *issued*. A permit issued before 1 January 2027 keeps your whole build on the 2021 stack, however long it runs. A permit issued on or after that date lands on the 2024 stack. If you are permitting in late 2026, that single date is worth more to your schedule than anything else on this page — and if you slip past it, ask your plan reviewer which edition your drawings are being reviewed against before you resubmit.

Two changes worth knowing in advance. At the rollover the wind and seismic sections stop pointing at the Council's county maps and the ATC website and point instead at the **ASCE Hazard Tool** — so the map advice on the next page has a shelf life. And South Carolina's own amendments are renumbered: the termite provisions move from R318 to **R305**, and the sprinkler section from R313 to **R309**. Same rules, different addresses.

How often that happens is now a four-year question, not a three-year one: R.8-240(A) requires the Council to adopt the latest editions “at least every four (4) years,” a change made effective 24 May 2024. Adoption runs through a Notice in the State Register, a comment period “of not less than one hundred eighty days,” a study committee and at least one public meeting, and the Council “shall determine whether the amended or modified code becomes effective on the first day of January or July” (§ 6-9-40).

THE ENERGY STANDARD IS A STATUTE, NOT A CODE

This is the South Carolina answer that confuses everyone, and it has a clean explanation. The Building Codes Council **does not adopt the energy chapter of the residential code at all** — R.8-1230 reads, in full: “IRC Chapter 11 Energy Efficiency. The Building Codes Council does not adopt IRC Chapter 11.”

What applies instead is the **Energy Standard Act**, Title 6 Chapter 10, and it names its own edition in the statute: “The 2009 edition of the International Energy Conservation Code is adopted as the Energy Standard. All new and renovated buildings and additions constructed within the State must comply with this standard” (§ 6-10-30). That sentence was last changed by 2012 Act No. 143, effective 1 January 2013, which “substituted ‘2009’ for ‘2006’.”

So the reason South Carolina is on a 2009 energy code is not inertia at the code council. **The council has no power over it.** Moving the energy standard takes an act of the General Assembly, and the last one was in 2012.

Four things in the Energy Standard Act you will not find in the code book

	What it says	Cite
Fireplaces	"Notwithstanding Section 402.4.3 of the 2009 Edition of the International Energy Conservation Code, new wood-burning fireplaces shall have tight-fitting flue dampers and outdoor combustion air. " A statutory requirement, not a code one.	§ 6-10-35
Who enforces it	"Local building officials shall enforce the provisions of the Energy Standard." Where there is no building official the jurisdiction may designate its engineer, director of public works, or chief fire inspector.	§ 6-10-50(A), (B)
What non-compliance costs	The official "shall notify the permit holder in writing to bring the building into compliance... or to secure it from entry or both; if the permit holder fails to comply... the building official shall revoke the permit. "	§ 6-10-50(E)
Log and recreational buildings	Local jurisdictions "must provide an appeals board and process for the routine granting of variations" for residential recreational dwellings not intended as permanent residences and for buildings "such as log buildings which, if insulation were required on the walls, would change the character" of them.	§ 6-10-70(A)
Modular	An energy variation granted to a local jurisdiction "shall apply only to site constructed buildings." A properly labeled modular building is accepted as in full compliance.	Reg. 8-250(D)

One wrinkle worth knowing before you argue with anyone: an Editor's Note to Chapter 10, quoting 1997 Act No. 123, Section 6, provides that "Chapter 10 of Title 6 of the 1976 Code is not applicable in counties or municipalities which have fully implemented building codes as required in Section 6-9-10." Read together with R.8-1230, the practical answer in every jurisdiction is the same 2009 IECC — but if a plan reviewer cites a different energy edition, that note is where the argument comes from. Ask, and write the answer down.

GETTING A REAL WIND NUMBER FOR YOUR PARCEL

South Carolina is one of the few states carrying serious hurricane exposure and a serious earthquake zone at once, and it handles both the same way: **by map, delegated to your building official.** The modified wind section reads:

"Buildings and portions thereof shall be constructed in accordance with the previously published maps by the South Carolina Building Codes Council. **The local building official may delineate the wind design category within their jurisdiction** provided that it does not surpass those provided on the Applied Technology Council (ATC) website."

IRC Section R301.2.1 as modified, S.C. Code of Regs. 8-1202. The same section keeps the continuous load path requirement — "A continuous load path shall be provided to transmit the applicable uplift forces in Section R802.11 from the roof assembly to the foundation" — and sends asphalt shingles to R905.2.4 and metal roof shingles to R905.4.4 for wind speed.

Why this kit does not print a wind speed for your county

Because South Carolina law forbids the state from drawing the line that way. Section 6-9-105(C): “Where a boundary for a physical or climatological condition is referenced in a code, the council, upon adoption of the code, is required to define the boundary so that it approximates the physical or climatological area, using logical geographic features such as major highways, waterbodies, or ridgelines. **Political boundaries may not be used unless they approximate the physical area.**”

A table of design wind speeds by county is therefore an approximation of a boundary the statute specifically declines to draw on county lines — and on the coast the difference between one side of a highway and the other is real money in straps, sheathing and glazing. Two lots in the same county, ten miles apart, do not get the same answer.

The maps do exist, and you can download them. They are at [llr.sc.gov/bcc/maps.aspx](http://lr.sc.gov/bcc/maps.aspx) — “Wind/Seismic Maps,” one free PDF per county, reachable from the Council's Building Code Adoption page rather than from its Codes page. The Council's own wording: the maps “are intended to be **the primary source** for defining the appropriate boundaries for wind and seismic design in South Carolina for single- and two-family dwellings.”

Three things to know before you open one. They are hand-drawn contour lines over old highway sheets, and **interpolating between the lines is expressly the building official's call**, not yours. The maps approved for the current code cycle are keyed to the **2015 IRC** — an older wind standard than the 2021 code they sit inside. And **eleven counties have no approved map at all**: Anderson, Cherokee, Greenville, Greenwood, Laurens, McCormick, Oconee, Pickens, Spartanburg, Sumter and Union — which includes the three largest Upstate markets.

For those eleven the regulation and the Council both send you to the Applied Technology Council website. **As of September 2026 that site is offline**, returning a “Website Suspended” placeholder. The working substitute is the **ASCE Hazard Tool** at ascehazardtool.org, which is live, free, takes a street address and returns wind, seismic, snow and flood parameters. Use it to arrive informed — but the number that governs your permit is the one your building official gives you in writing. Record it below.

For orientation only, and not a substitute for asking: across the Council's published county maps South Carolina runs from about **115 mph** ultimate in the Upstate and Midlands to roughly **150 mph** on the immediate Atlantic shoreline of Horry, Georgetown and Charleston counties. Everything in between is interpolated by the local official, and a few counties carry a flat blanket value written on the map instead of contours.

Design criteria to confirm with your building official — write the answers here

	Item	Date	Confirmed by
☐	Ultimate design wind speed (V_{ult}), 3-second gust, Risk Category II mph _____ Confirmed by _____		
☐	Exposure category for this parcel (B, C or D) Category _____ Date _____		
☐	Is the parcel in a wind-borne debris region? If yes, what opening protection is required Yes / No _____ Requirement _____		
☐	Seismic design category from the Council's map as delineated here SDC _____ Confirmed by _____		
☐	Flood zone, and Base Flood Elevation if in one — plus any local freeboard above BFE Zone _____ BFE + freeboard _____		
☐	Frost depth used for footings in this jurisdiction Inches _____ Date _____		
☐	Ground snow load, if the office specifies one psf _____ Date _____		
☐	Termite probability designation for this parcel — “very heavy” changes what insulation you may use Designation _____		

SEISMIC: THE OTHER MAP

The seismic section is worded almost identically, and it is not a formality in the Lowcountry: “Buildings shall be assigned a seismic design category in accordance with the previously published maps by the S.C. Building Codes Council. The local building official may delineate the seismic design category within their jurisdiction, as long as it does not surpass those provided on the Applied Technology Council (ATC) website.”

IRC Section R301.2.2.1 as modified, S.C. Code of Regs. 8-1203. The same county maps carry the seismic categories, at lr.sc.gov/bcc/maps.aspx.

The seismic sentence that decides whether this costs you anything

A **detached** one- or two-family dwelling picks up the residential code's seismic provisions only in Seismic Design Categories D_0 , D_1 and D_2 . In category **C** a detached house does **not** trigger them — but a **townhouse** in category C does. That one distinction is the whole question for most Lowcountry lots, and Charleston County spans several categories, so the answer can change across a parcel line rather than a county line.

Two ways out if you land high. R301.2.2.1.1 lets the building official reclassify a site downward on soil conditions — that is how a geotech report can move a marginal Lowcountry lot from engineered back to prescriptive. And on the coast the wind trigger usually bites first anyway: once the ultimate design wind speed reaches 140 mph the prescriptive wind provisions stop applying and the house needs engineering regardless of what the seismic map says. R.8-1201 defines “Accepted Engineering Practice” for that case, requiring design “by a South Carolina licensed Architect or Engineer.”

THE TERMITE AMENDMENTS THAT DECIDE YOUR INSULATION ORDER

Every guide tells you South Carolina has bad termites. Here is the part that changes a purchase order. In areas designated “very heavy” for termite probability, the state code **bans foam plastic below grade on your foundation** and requires an inspection gap you have to build in deliberately.

IRC R318 as South Carolina modified it

	The rule	Cite
No foam below grade	“Extruded and expanded polystyrene, polyisocyanurate and other foam plastics shall not be installed on the exterior face or under interior or exterior foundation walls or slab foundations located below grade. ” Exceptions: structural members entirely noncombustible or pressure-preservative treated; and the interior side of basement walls.	R.8-1216
Six inches of clear above grade	“The clearance between foam plastics installed above grade and exposed earth shall be not less than 6 inches. ”	R.8-1216
A crawl space inspection gap	“For crawl space applications, foam plastic shall be installed so as to provide a termite inspection gap of no less than 6 inches along the top of the foundation wall and foundation sill plate.”	R.8-1216
A six-inch strip at the sill	“Where foam plastic is applied in accordance with R318.4, a continuous 6 inch strip centered along the sill plate shall be left open for termite activity inspection.”	R.8-1217

IRC R318 as South Carolina modified it

	The rule	Cite
A seventh treatment method	South Carolina adds to the IRC's list of subterranean termite control methods: "Treatments may be conducted as outlined in Section 27-1085 of the Rules and Regulations for the Enforcement of the SC Pesticide Control Act and enforced by the Clemson University Department of Pesticide Regulation. "	R.8-1215

S.C. Code of Regs. 8-1215 through 8-1217, modifying IRC Sections R318.1, R318.4 and R318.5. Two consequences to plan for: a below-grade exterior foam detail that is routine in other states cannot be built here, and your termite treatment is regulated by an agency — the Clemson University Department of Pesticide Regulation — that is neither your building department nor a health agency. Ask who signs the treatment record your inspector wants to see.

CRAWL SPACES AND SLABS: THE HUMIDITY AMENDMENTS

South Carolina rewrote the unvented crawl space section, deleted the code's own under-floor vapor retarder section, and set a thicker slab vapor retarder than the model code. If you are building over a crawl space in the Lowcountry, this is the page to hand your framer.

- **Unvented crawl space.** Exposed earth covered with a continuous vapor retarder meeting **ASTM E1745 Class A**; joints overlapped **6 inches** and sealed or taped; edges extending not less than **6 inches up the stem wall**, attached and sealed. Then *one* of: continuously operated mechanical exhaust at **1 cfm per 50 square feet** of crawl space floor area with an air pathway to the common area and insulated perimeter walls; a conditioned air supply at the same rate with a return air pathway; a plenum in an existing structure complying with M1601.5; or dehumidification sized to the manufacturer's specifications. (R.8-1221, modifying R408.3)
- **The model code's under-floor vapor retarder section is gone.** "Section R408.8 is deleted without substitution." (R.8-1223)
- **Slab vapor retarder is 10 mil, Class A.** "A minimum 10-mil vapor retarder conforming to ASTM E1745 Class A requirements with joints lapped not less than 6 inches shall be placed between the concrete floor slab and the base course or the prepared subgrade." Not required for utility buildings and unheated accessory structures, unheated storage rooms under 70 square feet and carports, flatwork, or where the building official approves based on local site conditions. (R.8-1225, modifying R506.2.3)
- **Access openings are specified.** Through the floor, not smaller than **18 by 24 inches**; through a perimeter wall, not less than **16 by 24 inches**; a below-grade through-wall access needs an areaway of at least the same size with its bottom below the threshold. (R.8-1222, modifying R408.4)
- **Piers are prescriptive, and exterior piers get a dowel.** Piers under interior bearing-wall girders: solidly grouted, minimum nominal dimension **8 inches**, maximum height ten times the nominal thickness. Piers under exterior bearing walls: solidly filled, "shall contain a minimum of one #4 dowel mid-depth," minimum nominal dimension 8 inches, and maximum height **four** times the nominal thickness — ten times only where accepted engineering practice shows enough foundation wall to resist the lateral loads. (R.8-1220, modifying R404.1.9.2)

WHAT SOUTH CAROLINA DELETED, AND WHAT IT ADDED

Deletions are worth as much as requirements when you are budgeting, and South Carolina has made several that other states have not.

Amendments that change a budget or a detail

	What South Carolina did	Cite
Deleted	Residential fire sprinklers. “An automatic residential fire sprinkler system shall not be required to be installed in one- and two-family dwellings” — and the same for townhouses built to R302.2.	R.8-1213
Deleted	Whole-house mechanical ventilation. “The Building Codes Council does not adopt IRC Section R303.4.”	R.8-1208
Deleted	Window fall protection. R312.2, R312.2.1 and R312.2.2 are all not adopted.	R.8-1212
Deleted	Whole-house surge protection. Said twice: IRC E3606.5 “is deleted without substitution,” and NEC Article 230.67 “including (A) through (D), does not apply in this State.”	R.8-1247; R.8-1106
Deleted	The 2020 NEC outdoor-outlet GFCI rule. “NEC Article 210.8(F) Outdoor Outlets. This article does not apply in this State.” Walk-out basement receptacles are also excluded from the basement GFCI requirement.	R.8-1104; R.8-1251
Deleted	The hose bibb section. IRC P2903.10 “is deleted without substitution.”	R.8-1245
Added	Three IRC appendices, adopted on purpose. Appendix AH Patio Covers, Appendix AJ Existing Buildings, and Appendix AQ Tiny Houses. Appendices are unenforceable in South Carolina unless named at adoption (R.8-236(D)) — these were named.	R.8-1255 to R.8-1257
Added	A guard trigger the model code does not have. Guards are required over 30 inches “and at any point where a downward slope exceeds 3V:12H within 36 inches horizontally to the edge of the open side. Insect screening shall not be considered as a guard. ”	R.8-1211
Added	Truss drawings on site. “Truss design drawings... shall be provided to the building official at the time of inspection. Truss design drawings shall be provided with the shipment of trusses delivered to the job site.” Twelve enumerated contents. Ask your supplier for the package in writing when you order.	R.8-1224; R.8-1227
Changed	Stair risers. “The maximum riser height shall be 7 3/4 inches. The maximum riser height for masonry stairs shall be 8 inches.”	R.8-1210
Changed	Dryer duct length. “The maximum length of a clothes dryer exhaust duct shall not exceed 35 feet from the dryer location to the wall or roof termination.” Terminations get a backdraft damper, and “screens shall not be installed at the duct termination.”	R.8-1234; R.8-1232

Amendments that change a budget or a detail

	What South Carolina did	Cite
Changed	Water service depth. “Water service pipe shall be installed not less than 12 inches deep and not less than 6 inches below the frost line. ”	R.8-1241

All from S.C. Code of Regs. Chapter 8, Articles 11 and 12 — the 2020 NEC and 2021 IRC modification summaries. Two of these are commonly misreported. A statute at § 6-9-55(C) bars enforcement of “Section 501.3 of the **2012** International Residential Code,” which was the fire protection of floors rule; the 2012 edition is not in force, and South Carolina does adopt the current version of that rule as R302.13, with exceptions for floors over a crawl space and for framing of 2×10 nominal or greater (R.8-1207). And the sprinkler answer is the regulation above, not § 6-9-55(B), whose July 2015 date has long passed.

THE PERMIT PACKAGE

South Carolina does not set a statewide list of what a residential permit application must contain, so the specifics are your office's. What follows is the set every South Carolina jurisdiction asks for in some form, plus the items this state's statutes add.

Gather before you file

	Item	Date	Notes
☐	Completed building permit application — signed by you, in person (§ 40-59-260(C)) Date _____		
☐	The owner-builder disclosure statement your office uses, read and signed Form name _____		
☐	Register-of-deeds notice forms, requested at the same visit (§ 40-59-260(D))		
☐	Name and license or registration number of every licensed contractor on the project — Chapter 11 requires an exempt owner to list them on the application (§ 40-11-420(C))		
☐	Two sets of construction drawings to the scale your office specifies, with the design criteria above shown on them		
☐	Site plan showing setbacks, driveway, well and septic components if applicable, and drainage		
☐	Deed or plat establishing ownership and the parcel identification number		

Gather before you file

	Item	Date	Notes
☐	Septic construction permit or public sewer availability letter		
☐	Well permit or public water availability letter		
☐	Floodplain documentation and elevation certificate if the parcel is in a mapped flood hazard area		
☐	Driveway or encroachment permit if you are connecting to a state-maintained road		
☐	Land disturbance or stormwater coverage if you will disturb one acre or more		
☐	Truss package, when it arrives — the drawings must be on site and given to the inspector (R.8-1224)		
☐	Termite treatment arrangement, and who will produce the record your inspector wants		
☐	Energy compliance documentation to the 2009 IECC, in the form your office accepts		
☐	Fee schedule read, and the payment method your office takes confirmed Estimate _____		

Fees are set locally: a county or municipality “may impose fees necessary and consistent with Section 6-9-30(B)” on a simple majority vote (§ 6-9-90), and the building official “may prescribe fees for construction permits and inspections” (§ 6-9-30(A)). No statewide schedule exists, which is why this kit gives you a line rather than a number.

Two exemptions that live in the licensing chapter, not the code

Small work needs no permit at all. Section 40-59-265, added by 2022 Act No. 186 effective 16 May 2022, lists work that is “exempt from building permit application requirements” statewide — including one-story detached accessory structures not exceeding 200 square feet, fences not over 7 feet, retaining walls not over 4 feet unless supporting a surcharge, decks not exceeding 200 square feet and not more than 30 inches above grade at any point, sidewalks and driveways, and finish work. SC.5 carries the full list.

Farm buildings are outside the code — if you file first. Section 6-9-65 bars a county or municipality from enforcing the building code on a farm structure, but only if “**before** constructing a farm structure” the owner files an affidavit with the building official stating that it is being built as one, including a statement of intended use. FEMA flood standards still apply, the jurisdiction may still require a permit, and a structure “originally qualifying as a ‘farm structure’ but later converted to another use” is not one.

SOURCES

Sources — every South Carolina claim in this document (verified September 2026)

What this document states	Authority
Every code edition in force, and the modifications to each	S.C. Code of Regs. Ch. 8, Arts. 8-14
Residential code provisions must be promulgated as regulations before they may be enforced	S.C. Code Ann. § 6-9-55(A)
Adoption procedure, 180-day comment period, January or July effective dates	S.C. Code Ann. § 6-9-40; Reg. 8-240
The 2021 suite was adopted 6 October 2021 with an implementation date of 1 January 2023	SC Building Codes Council, 2021 Code Adoptions notice
The 2024 suite and the 2023 NEC were adopted 26 August 2025 with an implementation date of 1 January 2027; the 2009 IECC does not move with them	SC Building Codes Council, 2024 Modifications Index
Wind and seismic county maps, and the note that they are the primary source	SC Building Codes Council, Wind/Seismic Maps
The permit issuance date fixes the code edition your house is inspected against	S.C. Code Ann. § 6-9-130; Reg. 8-236(B)
Statewide modifications are mandatory; local governments may not write their own building codes	Reg. 8-240(K); Reg. 8-236(C)
Climatological boundaries must follow geography, not political lines	S.C. Code Ann. § 6-9-105(C)

Sources — every South Carolina claim in this document (verified September 2026)

What this document states	Authority
Wind and seismic design categories come from Council maps as delineated by the local building official	Reg. 8-1202; Reg. 8-1203
The 2009 IECC is the Energy Standard, adopted by statute; the Council does not adopt IRC Chapter 11	S.C. Code Ann. § 6-10-30; Reg. 8-1230
Fireplace dampers and outdoor combustion air; energy enforcement and permit revocation; log and recreational variances	S.C. Code Ann. § 6-10-35, § 6-10-50, § 6-10-70
Termite amendments: no foam below grade, six-inch clearances, the inspection strip, and the Clemson treatment route	Reg. 8-1215, 8-1216, 8-1217
Unvented crawl spaces, deleted under-floor vapor retarder, 10-mil slab retarder, access openings, pier rules	Reg. 8-1220 to 8-1225
No residential sprinkler mandate; no whole-house ventilation or window fall protection; no surge protection; no outdoor-outlet GFCI rule	Reg. 8-1213, 8-1208, 8-1212, 8-1247, 8-1104, 8-1106
Appendices AH, AJ and AQ adopted; appendices otherwise unenforceable	Reg. 8-1255 to 8-1257; Reg. 8-236(D)
Statewide list of work needing no building permit	S.C. Code Ann. § 40-59-265
Farm structures are outside the code if an affidavit is filed first	S.C. Code Ann. § 6-9-65
Permit fees are set locally	S.C. Code Ann. § 6-9-30(A), § 6-9-90

Everything cited here is free to read, in three places. Statutes (**S.C. Code Ann. § 40-59-260**) are at **scstatehouse.gov** → Code of Laws, and the whole chapter loads at one address you can type directly — scstatehouse.gov/code/t40c059.php, where **t40** is the Title and **c059** the chapter, zero-padded to three digits. Titles used here: **6** local government (building codes, the Energy Standard Act), **15** the eight-year repose, **29** mechanics' liens, **40** licensing, **44** health, **48** the coast. Regulations are at **scstatehouse.gov/coderegs/**, by chapter number. **One warning when you look something up:** a search engine will still hand you pages naming **DHEC**, an agency that ceased to exist in 2024 — check the masthead of any septic, well or coastal page you land on before you trust it. Read September 2026.